

Linux Mint 21.2 gets a beta release

The highly anticipated beta release of Linux Mint 21.2 'Victoria' is now available for download. Serving as the stable series successor to last year's Linux Mint 21.1, this release is based on Ubuntu 22.04 LTS and runs on the Linux kernel 5.15.

Linux Mint 21.2 brings some exciting new features. Here are some of the standout highlights.

- Tap-to-click is now enabled by default on the login screen for a smoother experience.
- The Software Manager has a refreshed interface and includes Flatpaks for expanded software options.
- The popular image viewer, Pix, is updated to gThumb 3.12.2, enhancing the image viewing experience.
- New two-tone folder icons and full support for HEIF and AVIF image files offer more versatility.
- Xreader can now preview Adobe Illustrator documents, adding to its functionality.

Linux Mint 21.2 includes Cinnamon 5.8, which brings several modest changes such as redesigned tool tips, accent colours in desktop notifications, and new 'Cinnamon Styles' for easier and more consistent theming.

The main menu applet is now freely resizable. Users can easily adjust its size by grabbing the upper-right corner and dragging it to their desired dimensions. The release is available in three flavours: Cinnamon, Xfce, and MATE.

One exciting addition to Linux Mint 21.2 Cinnamon is a touchpad and touchscreen gesture support, powered by the open source TouchEgg project. While not enabled by default, users can access gesture support by opening the Gestures panel if their hardware is compatible.

Thunderbird 115 unveiled

A brand new version of the Thunderbird email client is out. Thunderbird 115, codenamed 'Supernova', has been released with some major UI changes that are bound to catch your attention. The latest version was available for download on Windows, macOS, and Linux starting July 11, and can be obtained from the revamped Thunderbird homepage.



Right from the moment you launch the new version, you'll notice significant differences. The spaces sidebar, introduced in Thunderbird 102, now extends to full height and remains collapsible if you prefer not to use it. The title bar has been revamped to incorporate both the 'Search' bar and the 'AppMenu' (main menu), providing a streamlined experience. When only the 'Inbox' is open, you'll finally get the sleek, flush look you've always desired.

Here are some key features of Thunderbird 115:

- Calendar benefits from an improved colour palette
- Sortable folder modes and the option to hide local folders enhance organisation
- Restyled 'density' controls provide customisation options
- Colourful new 'tags' view in the folder pane adds visual appeal
- Address Book improvements enhance usability
- Accessibility enhancements for improved user experience
- 'Move To' and 'Copy To' options added to the folder context menu for easier management
- Assorted OpenPGP enhancements for enhanced security
- OAuth2 support for Fastmail users
- Option to always show tray icon (Windows)

Existing Thunderbird users on macOS and Windows can update through the app itself in the coming days. Linux users should note that the update process may vary depending on their distribution.

To download Thunderbird 115 or update your existing client, visit the official Thunderbird website. Ubuntu users can obtain the latest release from the Snap Store, Flathub, or directly from the Thunderbird website.

Linux's desktop market share exceeds 3% for the first time

In a noteworthy development for the open source community, Linux has surpassed



the 3% market share threshold on desktop computers, indicating a substantial increase in usage. While Linux has long been a dominant force in smartphones and servers, its presence on desktops has traditionally been limited, hovering around the 2% mark. However, recent data reveals a remarkable uptick, with Linux now claiming over 3% of the desktop market.

Three years ago, during the peak